



Birla Institute of Technology & Science, Pilani

Dubai Campus

ACADEMIC-UNDERGRADUATE STUDIES DIVISION

Second Semester 2025-26

Course Handout Part II

Date: 30 January 2026

In addition to Part-I (General Handout for all courses appended to the timetable) this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course Number : GS F211

Course Title : Modern Political Concepts

Instructor-in-charge : Dr. Shamshad Ahmad Khan (shamshad@dubai.bits-pilani.ac.in, Chamber: 148)

1. Course description:

Nature and scope of Political Science; emergence and basis of the state; rights and duties; forms of government; democracy; fascism; capitalism; socialism; anarchism; communism; Maoism, radicalism; Gandhism

2. Scope and Objective:

The study of such a course gives precision and definiteness to the meaning of political terms and also helps to develop the spirit of citizenship. It seeks to develop clarity of thought and make the student understand intrinsic problems related to current politics and International Relations. One is enabled to apply political theory in present day conditions and needs. It is well known that the working of Government can be improved by honest and sincere efforts of men. Hence the study of political concepts is very valuable.

3. Course learning outcomes:

- CLO1 Understand the most fundamental vocabulary and concepts in political science
- CLO2 Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.
- CLO3 Apply different political concepts to understand political developments around the world.
- CLO4 Critically analyse the contemporary issues of national and international politics.

4. Text books and references:

- TB. Asirvatham, E., Political Theory, S. Chand, latest edition
RB1. Andrew Heywood, *Politics*, London, Palgrave Macmillan, Latest Edition.
RB2. Ferdinand Peter, *Politics*, Oxford University Press. 2018.
RB3. Catriona Mackinnon, *Issues in Political Theory*, Oxford University Press, 2019.

5. Course Format & Weekly Workflow: Face-to-face lectures & 3 lectures in a week

6. Course plan:

S. No.	Topics to be covered	Lect no.	Ref.	Learning Outcome
1	Definition, nature and scope of Political Science	1	TB Ch.1	Explain the most fundamental vocabulary and concepts in political science
2	State-definition, elements, distinction with Govt. Nation and associations.	2-4	TB Ch.4,5	Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.
3	Functions of the State	5-6	TB Ch.9,10	Apply different political concepts to understand political developments around the world.
2	Rights and Duties	6-7	TB Ch.16,17, Class Notes	Critically analyse the contemporary issues of national and international politics.
5	Forms of Govt., meaning, merits and demerits	8-9	TB Ch.23,24, Class Notes	Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.
6	Democracy-meaning, merits and demerits.	10-11	TB Ch.25, 26	Explain the most fundamental vocabulary and concepts in political science
7	Toleration	12-13	Ref 1 Ch. 7	Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.
8	Liberalism	14-16	Ref 1, Ch. 2, Class Notes	Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.
9	Fascism	17-19	Ref 1, Ch 2	Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.
10	Capitalism	20-21	Ref 1, ch.2	Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.

11	Socialism	22-23	TB Ch. 9,13	Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.
12	Communism	24-26	TB Ch 30,31	Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.
13	Maoism	27-28	TB Ch 30	Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.
14	Radicalism	29-33	Class Notes	Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.
15	Gandhism	34-38	TB Ch. 35, Class notes	Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.
16	Politics, Society and Identity	39-42	Ref.1, Ch.7	Analyse, discuss, and apply ideas to a wide variety of political and social contexts.

7. Evaluation Scheme:

CEC No	Evaluation Components	Nature of Component	Duration	Weightage %	Date & Time	Venue
1	Quiz-1	Close Book	10 min	10	05.03.26 Th8	TBA (To be annou nced)
2	Mid Sem	Close Book	90 min	20	02.04.2026 FN	
3a	Project based Assignment (Mid-Sem Report)	Open Book	–	10	TBA	
3b	Project based Assignment Presentation	Open Book	-	10	TBA	
3c	Project based Assignment (Final Report)	Open Book	–	10	TBA	
4	Comprehensive Exam	Close Book	3 hours	40	02.06.2026 AN	

A student should obtain 40% of the median marks of the class to clear the course. If any student gets the marks lower than the prescribed standard mentioned above, he/she may be awarded NC.

9.Attendance Policy: Each student is expected to attend all classes and participate in all evaluation components. A student should have a minimum of 60% of attendance in a course to be eligible to appear for the Comprehensive Examination in that course.

10.Chamber consultation hours: W5

11. Makeup Policy: Make-ups are not given as a routine. It is solely dependent upon the genuineness of the circumstances under which a student fails to appear in a scheduled evaluation component. In such circumstances, prior permission should be obtained from the Instructor-in-Charge (I/C). The decision of the I/C in the above matter will be final.

**Instructor-in-charge
GS F211**